If Heaven Is Anywhere...

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31991962.

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
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by ScorchFlame

Summary

"Adora?"

"Sir Adora," she corrected with a soft smile that pulled at the lingering scar from their childhood. "You seemed a bit trapped." She offered a leather gloved hand, lowering her head in a respectful nodding bow. "If it pleases you, Your Grace… I thought I would invite you to dance with me."

Catra swallowed thickly, unfamiliar with the sputtering of her heart in her chest. "I… believe it would please me very much," she answered softly, taking the waiting hand.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra was purring softly as she laid curled up in bed. She'd woken up to the sun streaming through the window half an hour ago, but she was too content to even begin to think to stir. She lazily opened her eyes to smile softly up at the woman wrapped around her, long blonde locks draping over the pillows and over her broad shoulder. Catra let out a quiet sigh, studying the dozing face of her knight.

It was true that Adora served the kingdom of Bright Moon and their royal family. But that didn't matter to either of them. In the quiet of the evening, Adora swore herself and her service to C'yra of House D'riluth, third of her name, Princess of Halfmoon, heir to the throne of the three underkingdoms. Sir Adora didn't care that it made her an oathbreaker to House Bright Moon. She had been adamant that Catra had already fully and completely captured her, heart and soul, and to do otherwise would be an even worse sort of betrayal. Though that made things difficult.

Few and far between were the visits between the Halfmoon and Bright Moon dignitaries. Though every opportunity given, both were eager to be part of the envoy at the prospect of seeing the other, even for just a brief time. Spending their days in court shooting each other furtive glances, their evenings strolling among gardens, and their nights wrapped up in each other's arms. It was always so sweet, but then again never enough. Never enough kisses, never enough caresses, never enough whispered words of love and devotion… never enough time. They always worked to steal more time.

What else were they to do? With Adora a knight and Catra a princess, both from kingdoms separated by miles long and fathoms below. But they were determined to make every second they were allotted count.

They had known each other for a long while, and at first, they hadn't much cared for the other. At minimum, every summer the kingdoms of Halfmoon and Bright Moon would come together. Adora, even as a young Page, always tagged along with her best

friend Princess Glimmer and her fellow Page, Bow. More often than not, it would be those three traipsing around, excluding young Princess C'yra from their games. Determined and stubborn as ever, she wouldn't let them alone if for no other reason than to taunt and tease them. Especially Adora. Catra found her to be the most insufferable of the lot. Catra had learned very quickly that the little Page was easily flustered, but the magicat Princess took great joy in seeing her pale skin turn bright red.

Every summer was dreaded. Secret exclusive forts, card games, horseback riding, and so many other such things. While all seemed like good fun to the adults in their lives thinking the children were fostering good friendships that would strengthen the alliance between the two nations, more often than not trips were made to the infirmary when things were taken too far. In fact, Adora had decided when they were about fifteen that it would be funny to pull her tail. The Squire walked away from the incident with three deep scars from cheek to jaw line when Catra retaliated to the indignity. But the lesson was well learned.

It wasn't until three summers later when they all came together again that things began… changing.

Catra recalled it vividly.

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A grand ball had been orchestrated in the honor of… some noble or another. Catra didn't care to pay attention. So long as she presented herself in the deep red flowing dress her mother insisted she wear, and she conducted herself politely, she would have fulfilled her duty.

The magicat's tail lashed in agitation as she turned down yet another young lordling for a dance. She was the picture of grace and dignity as she respectfully declined, but any that knew her could see that she was seconds from clawing at the next presumptuous noble that insisted she dance with them.

"Your Grace?" Came a voice that was… alien, but at the same time so familiar.

Catra turned and blinked as she tilted her head up to meet those grey blue eyes she knew so well. A custom tailored doublet in the lavenders and pale blues of Bright Moon, dark breeches with a line of gold embroidered along the outer legs, a tooled white belt at her hips, knee high polished leather boots, and a fine thick gold chain hung about her neck. Catra's ears laid back against her perfectly coiffed hair. Not in anger or agitation, but surprise. And… what was that feeling pooling in her gut?

"Adora?"

"Sir Adora," she corrected with a soft smile that pulled at the lingering scar from their childhood. "You seemed a bit trapped." She offered a leather gloved hand, lowering her head in a respectful nodding bow. "If it pleases you, Your Grace… I thought I would invite you to dance with me."

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That had been the first night they kissed alone in the gardens. The night they realized that the whole of their childhood antics was merely an expression of affection they'd always held but hadn't yet learned the words to understand what those feelings meant.

Which brought them here three summers later, to Catra's guest bedchamber in Bright Moon after a long night of love making.

Adora sucked in a deep breath through her nose, her grip on her lover growing stronger. "Good morning, beautiful," she murmured, pressing tired kisses to her neck and collar.

Catra giggled, combing her claws through Adora's hair. "Good morning, dummy."

"We slept in," groaned the knight, burying her face in her love's flowing dark tresses.

"*You* slept in," the princess corrected with a fanged grin. "I figured after last night, you'd earned a few extra hours of sleep."

Adora sighed heavily. "You should've woken me."

Catra hummed, continuing to run her fingers through Adora's hair. "And miss the chance to see you finally relax? Not on your life, good Sir," she teased.

With a chuckle, Adora sat up just enough to press their lips together in morning greeting. "I should've gone to my own rooms by now."

"Bow will cover for you," Catra countered. "He always does."

"I don't want to have to put him through more than is absolutely necessary," Adora retorted before moving to climb out of bed.

Catra tsked, taking hold of the linen sleeve of Adora's shirt. "My love, don't go," she nearly whispered. "Stay with me…"

Adora turned to smile softly at the woman she wanted to wake up to every morning until her last. "I'll see you at breakfast, my heart."

"It isn't the same, and you know it," the magicat answered, ears laying back in irritation. "I can't take this hiding. I want you for my own. I don't want to share you with Bright Moon any longer." Her tugging won out, and she pulled Adora into her arms, cradling her knight's head against her chest. "Come with me, Adora…"

Blue eyes slowly fell shut, arms wrapping firmly around Catra's waist. "Catra… I…"

"Just! Before you say no, take the next few days to think on it. I won't be leaving for Halfmoon until week's end."

Adora nodded slowly, turning her head to press a kiss to Catra's navel. "I will think on it."

"Promise?" Amber and sapphire eyes softened when they were met with deep blue.

"I promise," Adora whispered.

They lingered in that moment, Catra tracing her thumb down the scars along her lover's jaw. But just as every sweet moment between them, it couldn't last.

Adora reluctantly moved to sit up and stole a final deep long kiss before finally climbing out of bed. "In the meantime," she murmured, "I need to get back to my quarters. Bow covering for me or not, I will need to make an appearance eventually."

Catra sighed mournfully as she watched her love slowly dress, working to meticulously strap on every piece of armor that had sat at the foot of their bed. She could never deny just how handsome Adora looked in her bright breastplate and flowing red cape, broadsword at her hip. Finally, Catra moved to dress herself knowing that she would be expected to put in her own appearance at breakfast. She could almost feel Adora's eyes on her as she did, and smiled softly to herself knowing that she was pleasing to behold. Sure, other members of the court and prospective suitors were quick to comment on her beauty, but the only opinion that mattered was her Adora's.

With the final adjustments to her crown, she turned to see her knight moving to climb out of the window and she rushed forward. "Excuse you, good Sir Knight," she huffed, crossing her arms over her chest.

"Yes, my princess?" Adora crooned, straddling the windowsill, a smug expression taking up residence on her face.

“You aren’t to leave until I bid you to.”

Adora hummed, placing a hand against the stone to brace herself. “Your Grace, my princess, love of my life… may I take my leave?”

Catra’s tail lashed momentarily as she stepped closer, wrapping her arms around Adora’s neck. “Not just yet,” she murmured before leaning into a deep kiss. She sighed quietly, feeling a strong hand at her waist and another gently tracing down her arm. She felt her fur stand on end at the pleasant sensation, their kiss growing in hunger and intensity with each passing second, neither knowing the next time they would have the chance to hold one another again.



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Regretfully, their lips parted, and they instead pressed their foreheads together to soak in the feeling of the other for just a

moment longer.

“I love you,” Catra whispered, just loud enough to be heard over the uncontrollable rolling purr rumbling from her chest.

“I love you,” Adora answered, her lips brushing against Catra’s as she spoke. “Do I have your permission to take my leave *now*, my love?”

With no small amount of remorse, Catra nodded her consent. “You have it,” she answered. “But only if you swear to find me in the gardens after the lunch hour.”

“As my princess commands,” Adora replied with a final peck before slipping out of the window.

End Notes

So for those of you that watched me give Kaifu a mental breakdown over stream, this is me making it up to them /lh lol

Per her request, I wrote a cute little blurb based on this piece on their twitter

Thank you to my partner in crime Jenna for beta reading for me. Thank you sissy ♡ Also, Tara "Buzzer Beater" Stark!

Here's my twitter and my tumblr. Hit me up if you like. I love talking to people my fics, Catradora, or just spop in general.

I also made discord! Come hang out!

I hope you all like it! Thank you for reading!

Comments and kudos are life-giving. ♡

(Ps. Yes, I am still working on 'Let Me Be The Place That You Hide'. It's coming along. Pumping out 10k words per chapter with school starting up for me again has been difficult. Plus this last month has just been hella crazy in general. But I am working on it, I promise.)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!